

DECENT COACHING CLASSES

Active & Passive Voice

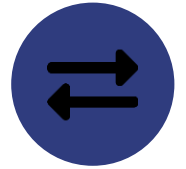
Who does the action — and who receives it?

Structure • Golden Rules • Tense-wise Formulae • Special Cases

Class 3 | 5th August

For Classes VIII, IX & X — Maharashtra Board & NCERT

What is Voice in Grammar?



Learning objective: apply the correct tense-conversion rules while changing voice

Voice refers to the form of a verb that shows whether the subject PERFORMS the action or RECEIVES it. English has two voices — Active Voice and Passive Voice.

ACTIVE VOICE

The subject DOES the action.

The dog chased the ball.

PASSIVE VOICE

The subject RECEIVES the action.

The ball was chased by the dog.

Only TRANSITIVE verbs (verbs with a direct object) can be changed from active to passive. An intransitive verb (sleep, arrive, go) has no object to promote into a subject.

Active Voice

The subject is the doer — direct, clear and to the point



STRUCTURE: Subject + Verb + Object (optional)

- In active sentences, the subject performs the action.
- Active voice generally makes writing clearer and more direct.
- We use the active voice to say what the subject DOES.
- The subject always comes BEFORE the verb.

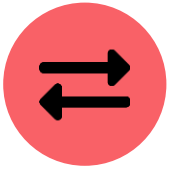
Examples

"The chef cooked the meal." (Chef = subject, performing the action of cooking)

"She writes a letter." (Subject = She; Verb = writes; Object = a letter)

Passive Voice

The subject receives the action — useful when the doer is unknown or unimportant



STRUCTURE: Object (becomes subject) + "be" + V3 (past participle) + by + original subject (optional)

- In passive voice, the subject receives the action — it does not perform it.
- The doer of the action comes AFTER the verb, usually introduced by "by".
- Useful when the action matters more than the actor, or the actor is unknown.
- Can be used to emphasize the action or the recipient of the action.

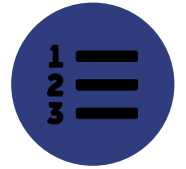
Examples

"The meal was cooked by the chef." (Meal = subject, receiving the action of cooking)

"A letter is written by her." (Subject = A letter; Verb = is written; Agent = by her)

Active Voice vs Passive Voice

Key differences to remember



Active Voice	Passive Voice
Denotes that the subject is PERFORMING the action.	Denotes that the subject is ACTED UPON by the verb.
Does not require a linking verb to make sense.	Uses a linking ("be") verb + past participle of the main verb.
Focuses on the DOER of the action.	Comes in handy when the doer of the action is unknown or unimportant.
Has a direct, clear and strong tone.	Has a more indirect, softer and subtler tone.
Example: I decorated the hall.	Example: The hall was decorated by me.

The Five Golden Rules

Follow these steps in order, every single time



1

Object becomes the Subject

2

Choose the correct form of the verb 'be'

3

Use the Past Participle Form (V3) of the verb

4

Add 'by'

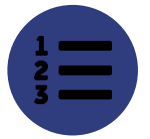
5

Subject becomes the Object

FORMULA: Object + verb 'be' + V3 + by + Subject

She helps him. → He is helped by her.

The Master Table — Active & Passive Formulae

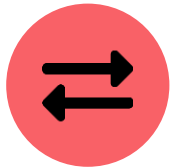


Every tense, both voices, structure and example — keep this slide for revision

TENSE	ACTIVE STRUCTURE	PASSIVE STRUCTURE	EXAMPLE
Present Simple	S+V1(+s/es)+O	O+is/am/are+V3+by+S	<i>She writes a letter. → A letter is written by her.</i>
Present Continuous	S+is/am/are+V1ing+O	O+is/am/are+being+V3+by+S	<i>She is writing a letter. → A letter is being written by her.</i>
Present Perfect	S+has/have+V3+O	O+has/have+been+V3+by+S	<i>She has written a letter. → A letter has been written by her.</i>
Present Perfect Continuous	S+has/have+been+V1ing+O	— No Passive —	<i>She has been writing a letter.</i>
Past Simple	S+V2+O	O+was/were+V3+by+S	<i>She wrote a letter. → A letter was written by her.</i>
Past Continuous	S+was/were+V1ing+O	O+was/were+being+V3+by+S	<i>She was writing a letter. → A letter was being written by her.</i>
Past Perfect	S+had+V3+O	O+had+been+V3+by+S	<i>She had written a letter. → A letter had been written by her.</i>
Past Perfect Continuous	S+had+been+V1ing+O	— No Passive —	<i>She had been writing a letter.</i>
Future Simple	S+will/shall+V1+O	O+will/shall+be+V3+by+S	<i>She will write a letter. → A letter will be written by her.</i>
Future Continuous	S+will/shall+be+V1ing+O	— No Passive —	<i>She will be writing a letter.</i>
Future Perfect	S+will/shall+have+V3+O	O+will/shall+have+been+V3+by+S	<i>She will have written a letter. → A letter will have been written by her.</i>
Future Perfect Continuous	S+will/shall+have+been+V1ing+O	— No Passive —	<i>She will have been writing a letter.</i>

Change of Pronouns

The subject pronoun in the active sentence becomes an object pronoun after "by"



Active Voice (Subject)	Passive Voice (Object, after "by")
I	Me
We	Us
He	Him
She	Her
They	Them
It	It

Special Cases — Two Objects & Phrasal Verbs



Not every sentence follows the plain formula

Sentences with TWO objects → TWO possible passives

He gave me a book. → *A book was given to me by him. / I was given a book by him.*

I told them a story. → *A story was told to them by me. / They were told a story by me.*

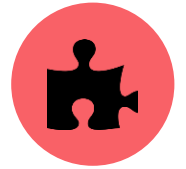
Intransitive verb + preposition acting as ONE transitive unit

All laughed at her. → *She was laughed at by all.*

He agreed to my proposal. → *My proposal was agreed to by him.*

"Everyone laughed at Rahul's joke" → passive keeps "laughed AT" together: "Rahul's joke was laughed at by everyone" — drop the "at" and the sentence falls apart!

Special Cases — Commands, Questions & Modals



Imperatives, interrogatives, and sentences with 'can/may/ought to'

Imperative (command) sentences

Formula: Let + object + be + V3 (+ by + subject)

Open the door. → Let the door be opened.

Help me. → Let me be helped.

Don't eat this fruit. → Let not this fruit be eaten.

Interrogative (question) sentences

Formula: (Wh-word) + aux + subject + V3 + by + object

When did you write this letter? → When was this letter written by you?

How did you do this sum? → How was this sum done by you?

Passives WITHOUT 'by' (agent unknown, obvious or unimportant)

We call the dog Spot. → The dog is called Spot. They elected him king. → He was elected king.

Modal auxiliaries (can, may, ought to...) — Modal + be + V3

Can you ignore his mistake? → Can his mistake be ignored by you?

You ought to obey your elders. → Elders ought to be obeyed by you.

Practice — Convert the Voice

Change each sentence into the voice indicated



1. Varun is helping Reshmi. (→ passive)

2. A gift was given to Manassa by me. (→ active)

3. Santana will sing "All My Life" at the Nationals. (→ passive)

4. A mouse was being chased by my cat. (→ active)

5. Naveen loves Praveena. (→ passive)

6. The decorations for the annual day will be done by Emma. (→ active)

7. J. K. Rowling wrote the Harry Potter novels. (→ passive)

8. Ms. Holly will teach Spanish this year. (→ passive)

9. Mike was hit by Nick. (→ active)

10. Naslen is being scolded by his mom. (→ active)

Practice — Fill in the Blanks



Complete each sentence using the correct passive form of the verb given

1. It is a big college. More than a hundred teachers ____ (employ) there.

2. ____ (somebody/clean) the office yesterday?

3. How much of our country's land area ____ (cover) by forest?

4. The hostel gates ____ (lock) at 8.00 pm everyday.

5. The parcel ____ (send) a month ago and it ____ (arrive) only yesterday.

6. Where ____ (these photographs/take)? In Mumbai? ____ (you/take) them, or somebody else?

Previous Year Questions

Active & Passive Voice



Q1. Change into passive voice: "The teacher is checking the notebooks."

1 M

CBSE — 10

Q2. Change into active voice: "The window was broken by the boy."

1 M

SB — 9

Q3. Change into passive voice: "They will complete the project by Monday."

2 M

CBSE — 10

Q4. Rewrite in passive voice: "Can you solve this problem?"

1 M

SB — 8

Q5. Change into active voice: "Let the winner be announced."

2 M

CBSE — 9

Q6. Change into passive voice: "Who is calling me?"

1 M

SB — 10

Quick Recap



Active vs Passive

Active: subject DOES the action. Passive: subject RECEIVES the action.



Five Golden Rules

Object → Subject; correct 'be' form; V3; add 'by'; Subject → Object.



Master Table

12 tenses × 2 voices — 4 combinations have NO passive form (all the perfect-continuous / future-continuous slots).



Special Cases

Two objects → two passives; phrasal verbs keep their preposition; imperatives use 'Let...be...'; modals use 'be + V3'.



Practice Makes Perfect!

Homework: complete the practice exercises and revise the Master Table before the next class.

Questions? Ask now!